

Building **AI Discoverability** Capabilities Against a Moving Target

A roadmap for strengthening a brand's presence in AI answers by folding the work into Integrated Marketing.

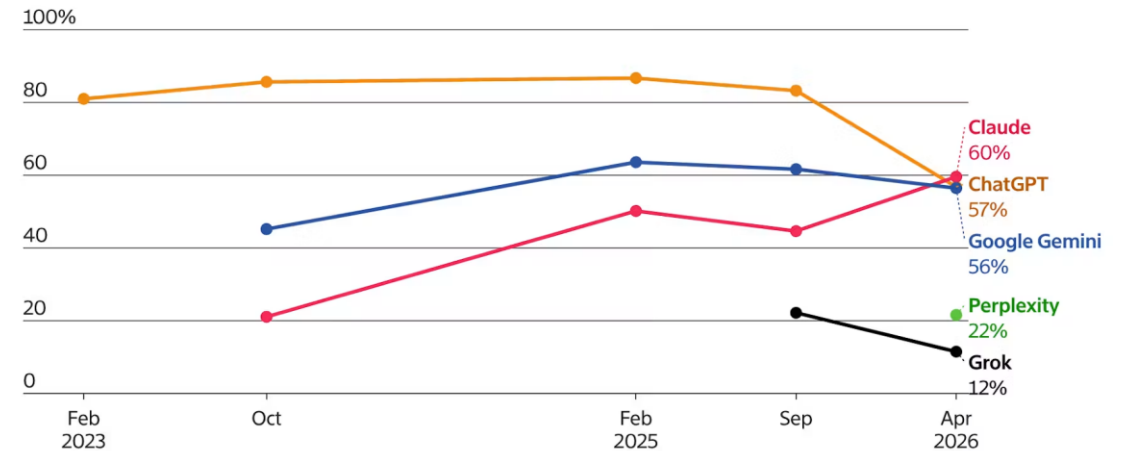
The emergence of platforms and finite budgets requires marketers to find synergies when deploying resources across touchpoints

Managing social, retail media, AI platforms in isolation risks each one receiving insufficient support, compounding an organization's sunk costs.

AI discoverability specifically can look like a speculative bet due to

- Dynamic consumer adoption
- Changes to each platform's algorithm
- Lack of standardized measurement
- Limited attribution
- Latency between changes and impact

Do you use the following services?



Source: The Information Pro Surveys

Folding AI Discoverability into Integrated Marketing planning reduces the risk of sunk cost

Brands can build the capability without significant investment by assigning AI Discoverability accountability to a line item that already exists

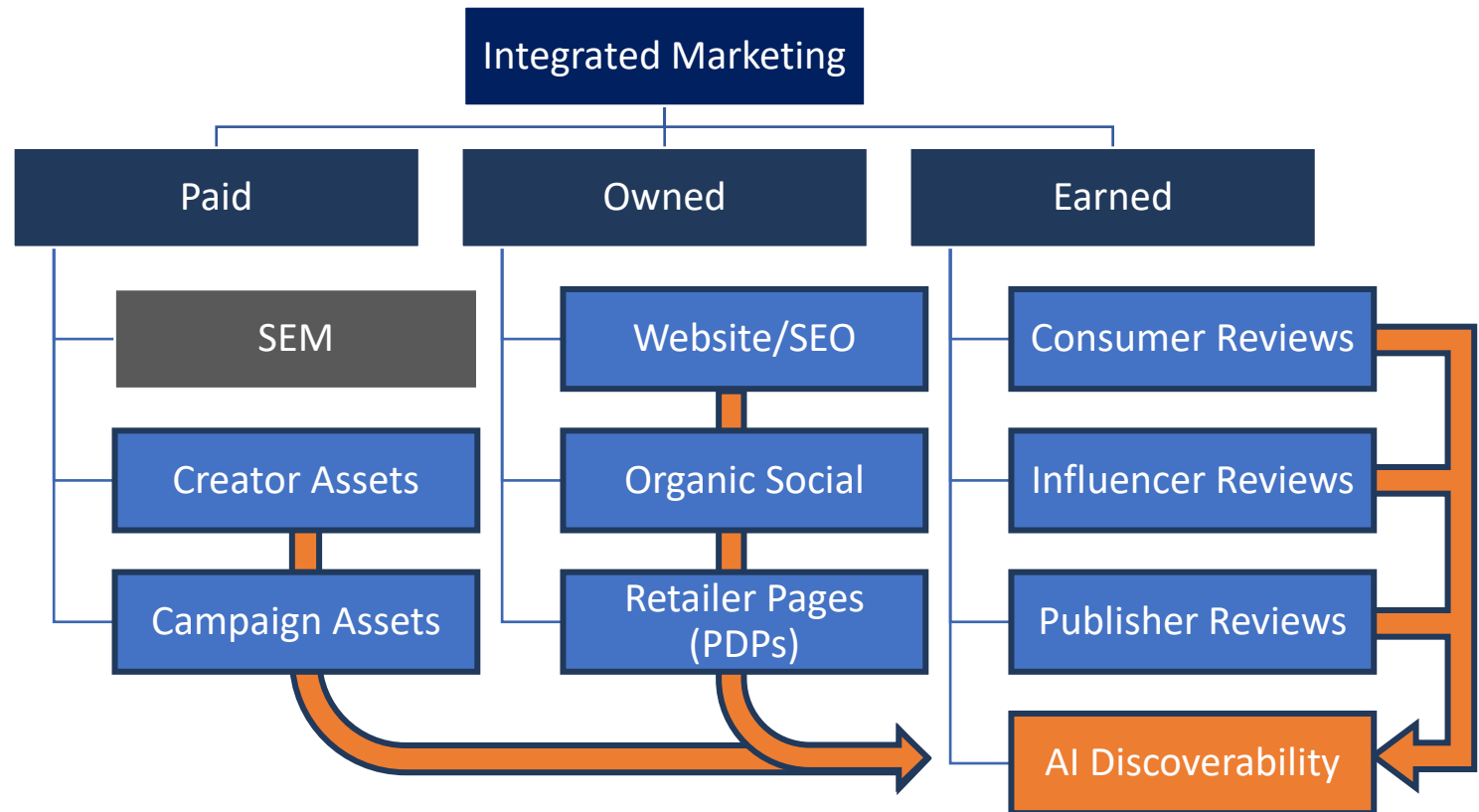
- 1 Nothing is stranded**
The incremental cost is near-zero because the assets and content still need to be created to support consumer initiatives.
- 2 No overclaiming**
Low incremental budgets reduce the need to manufacture results prior to establishing a standardized methodology for attribution.
- 3 Sharper prioritization**
Integrated Marketing investments become more intentional as AI Discoverability prioritizes/deprioritizes specific channels, without defunding Integrated Marketing efforts overall.

Digiday, “Marketers shift growing shares of search spending to GEO” (2026), citing Scribewise: 55% of marketers already carry GEO budget; ~70% of them put it at 11–20% of spend.

Integrated Marketing should be responsible for AI Discoverability because it is a product of that team's work

Influencing AI Discoverability isn't managing a channel; it's a messaging strategy aimed at key opinion leaders.

Advertisers who build bespoke teams or expand the remit of Search Teams to improve AI Discoverability miss that AI platforms ingest the full spectrum of content.



Accounting for the internal and external forces that shape Generative AI adds value to the Integrated Planning process

Ongoing measurement of your team's impact and the Internal and External forces enable teams to proactively and retroactively respond to shifts in the landscape

Force Type	KPIs	Planning Align on the goal and how success will be measured.	Programming Define the work the initiative requires.	Publishing What you publish for machines and humans to read.
INTERNAL Things you can control and influence	Objective: Accuracy & Fidelity Representation accuracy rate (Primary) Content freshness & consistency Entity strength	1 Define how you want the brand to show up. Audit the content that already exists about your brand.	4 Develop a communications plan for how and where your brand will show up.	5 Deploy content across channels for humans and machines
EXTERNAL Things brands influence but don't control	Objective: Showing up at Scale Share-of-Model (Primary) Prominence (Secondary) Citation / source rate (Diagnostic)	2 Prioritize the platform(s) in which you want your content to appear	3 Prioritize the topics or prompts in which you want to appear based on relevance and volume of consumer interest.	6 Pivot with purpose as algorithm shifts, platform-publisher relationships change, and consumer adoption evolves

Audit what the models already say about your brand, and whether it is accurate and current

Modern SEO focuses on the present; AI-generated answers can pull from inaccurate or dated information. Track what it references, and if it changes over time.

1

Representation accuracy rate

% of answers across a fixed prompt panel that get your positioning, specs, and claims right. The core “are the machines getting the facts right” metric.

2

Content freshness & consistency

% of owned + retailer surfaces (PDPs, newsroom, affiliate) carrying current, non-contradictory specs, pricing, and packaging. Pure hygiene, fully in your control.

3

Entity strength

Knowledge Panel presence + entity salience (0–1) + schema / sameAs coverage. The controllable substrate that makes you citable.

Internal metrics are leading indicators — you can move them directly.

Track how brand exposure and preference change as you initiate efforts to indirectly influence the platforms

As control drops from SEM to SEO to AEO, the job shifts from buying the slot, to establishing the position, to earning your share of the answer.

1

Share-of-Model

Share of mentions and citations against the named competitor set, across the prompt panel and target engines. Measures the same instinct as brand Share-of-Voice.

2

Prominence

Average position. When you appear, are you the lead recommendation, a list item, or a footnote?

3

Citation / source rate

How often your owned or earned content is the source the model draws from, not just a passing mention. (Avinash Kaushik's Sources Analysis).

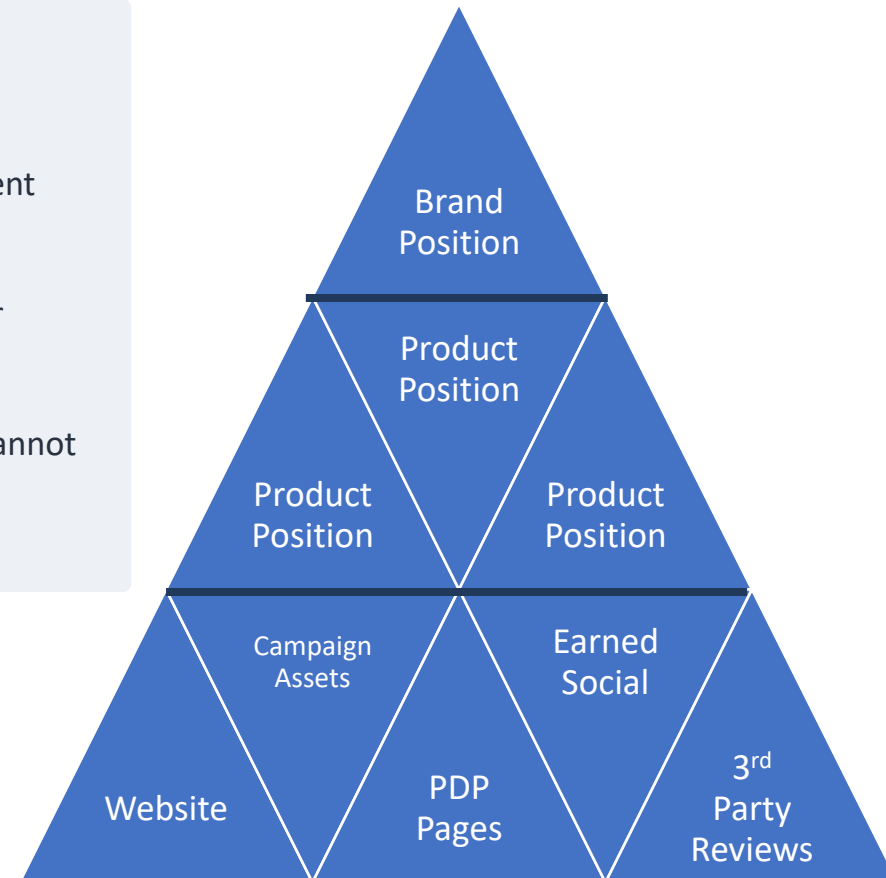
Define how you want the brand to show up

	Planning	Programming	Publishing
INTERNAL	1	4	5
EXTERNAL	2	3	6

AI Discoverability is a future-forward exercise, but Marketers must audit their existing digital thumbprint before pushing forward; Machine retrieval can penalize information that isn't consistent with what has already been ingested.

Audit the archives

- Ensure your product position (or multiple product positions) ladder into a consistent brand identity. Hyper-tailored messages can create inconsistency
- Make sure all owned messages are current or dated to discourage the use of older material that no longer reflects the brand
- Flag any historical information that can be referenced, positive or negative, that cannot be changed (e.g., product recall or negative reviews)

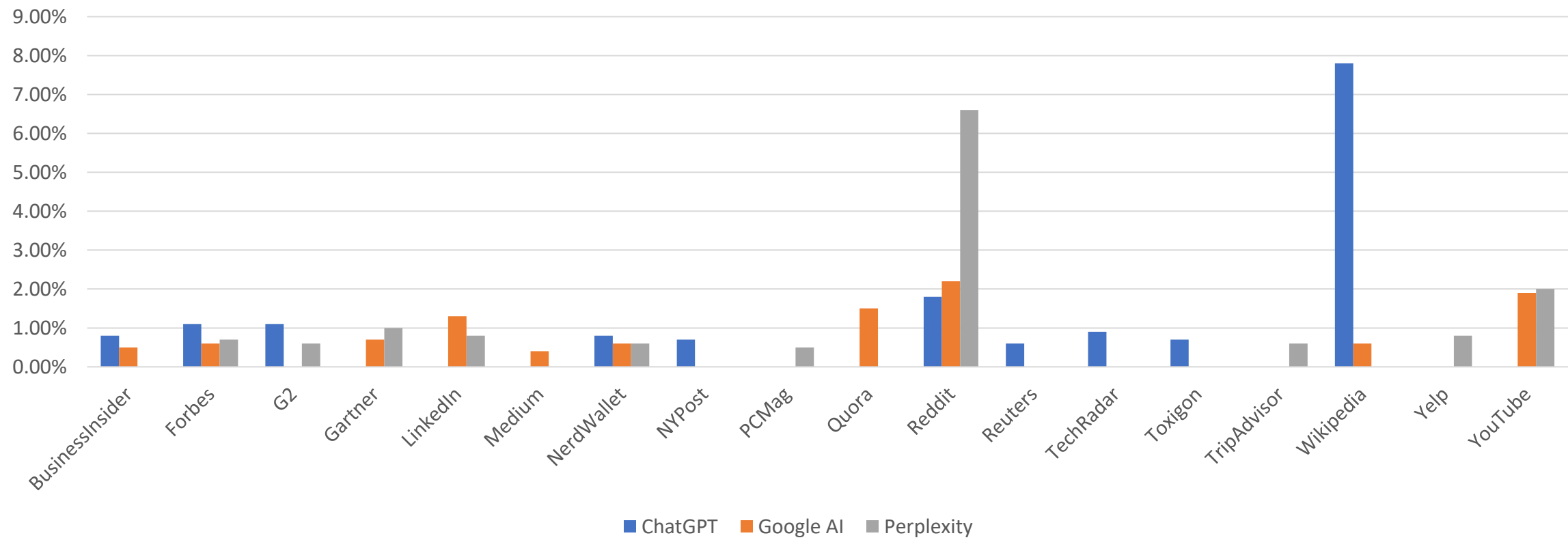


Learn which AI platforms your audience uses, and the sources those platforms cite

	Planning	Programming	Publishing
INTERNAL	1	4	5
EXTERNAL	2	3	6

Prioritize the platform(s) your consumers adopt for category questions, then earn presence on the sources those engines draw from.

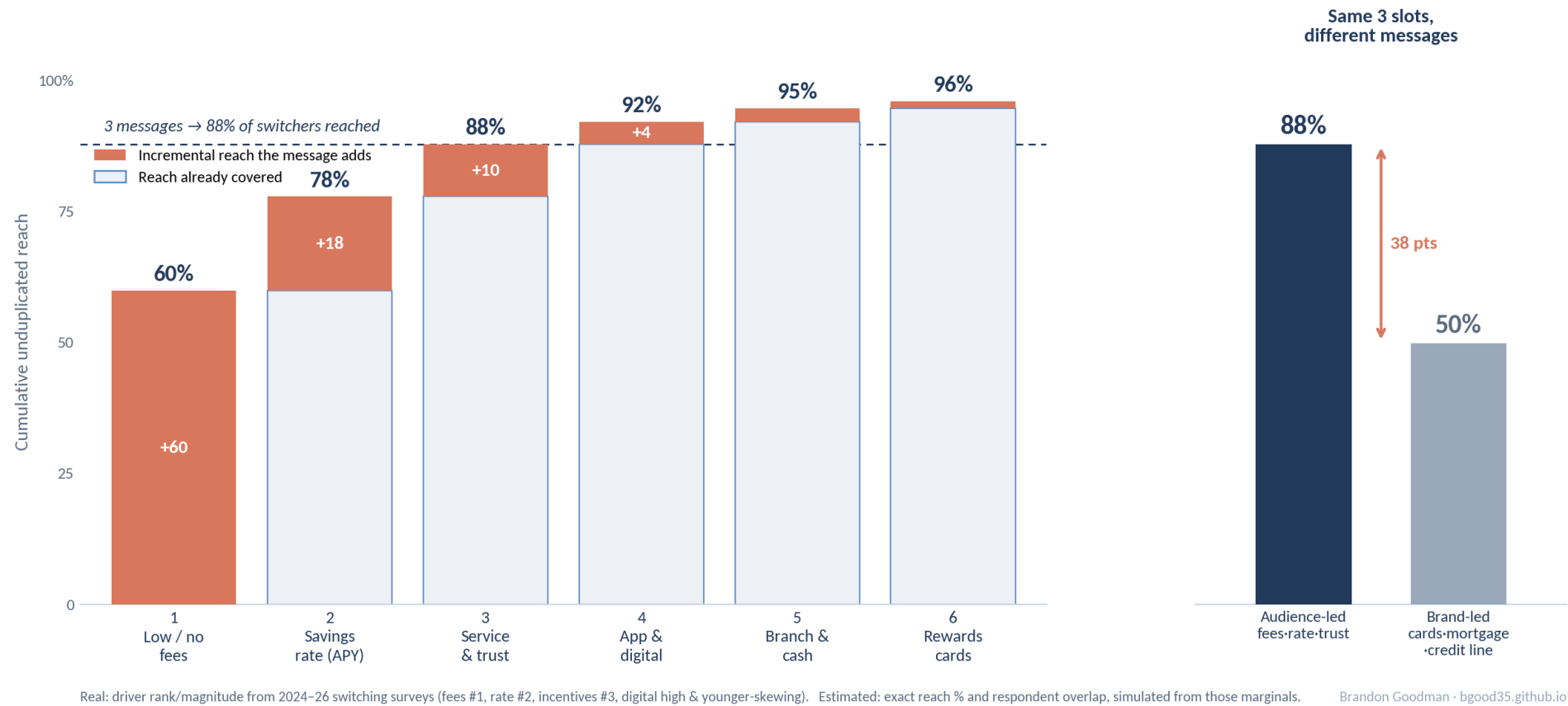
Top Source Share Distribution (Aug 2024 – June 2025)



Let what (and how) people are searching inform your messaging strategy

Conduct a TURF analysis to determine what questions people are asking about your brand or category.

	Planning	Programming	Publishing
INTERNAL	1	4	5
EXTERNAL	2	3	6



GEO wants specific answers to prompts; generalizations can dilute your authority

Ensure your content matches how questions are asked to AI platforms, and delivered in a way that is unique to your brand

	Planning	Programming	Publishing
INTERNAL	1	4	5
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THE MOVE

Ladder every asset to one keystone

A strong brand position is the advantage: make every piece of content ladder back to one keystone identity or domain of expertise.

Multiple use cases can help *if* each supports the overarching thesis and stays inside a domain the brand credibly owns.

THE DIFFERENCE

Machine retrieval isn't a scarce slot

A model's index isn't zero-sum, but models can downgrade content designed explicitly for AI consumption (cloaking). Consider producing versions of a message for different prompts, but only invest in amplifying the ones that would resonate with humans.

Build a calendar that determines how, when, and where your brand shows up

	Planning	Programming	Publishing
INTERNAL	1	4	5
EXTERNAL	2	3	6

Internal programming needs to account for both human and LLM consumption of the message, with an explicit attention to when new products, claims, packaging, or offers may change from what is currently in the market.

Positioning

Ensure all stakeholders are aware of where obsolete brand imagery lives, where it can be updated, or if its lack of recency/relevancy can be flagged.

Be clear if the brand will have a slightly different tone of voice by platform (e.g. Wendy’s)

Product/Service

Changes to a product or service may live on internal and external sources.

Establish processes to ensure retailer PDPs have accurate information (ingredients, portion sizes, etc.) and affiliate sites are showing the most recent rates/costs of a service.

Seasonality

Ensure that the content exists for AI to scrape information about products or services that have seasonal appeal prior to these moments (when possible), allowing AI to reference it when people start searching.

Packaging

Make sure that AI can recognize any changes to the visual identity of a brand, avoiding mischaracterization as a competitor or “knock-off” of the real thing.

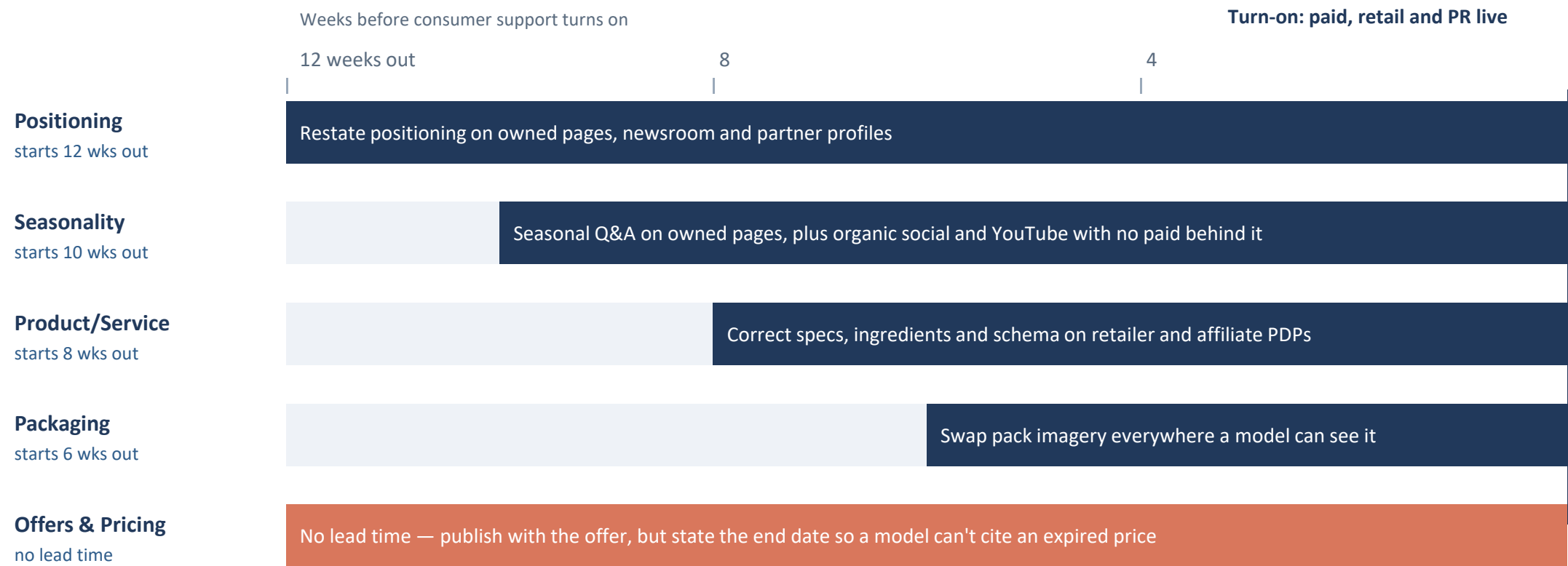
Offers & Pricing

Time-sensitive promotions, rates, and dynamic offers go stale fast. Make sure the model isn’t surfacing an expired price or a lapsed promotion; date or retire this content the moment it changes.

Influencing AI Discoverability requires an earlier start than consumer support

	Planning	Programming	Publishing
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The same five pillars from the content calendar, sequenced against the moment paid, retail and PR support goes live in full.



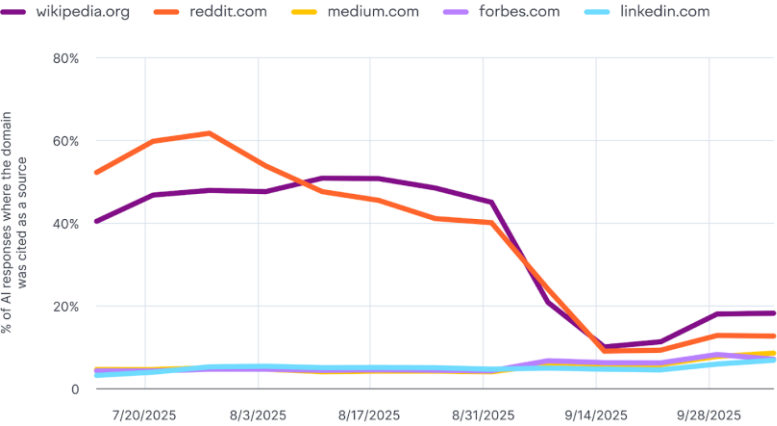
Lead times are planning defaults, not fixed rules: set each from how long your own pages take to be crawled, indexed and cited.

Learn & optimize based on announced changes and observed performance

	Planning	Programming	Publishing
INTERNAL	1	4	5
EXTERNAL	2	3	6

AI platforms’ relationships with humans and publishers are in a constant state of flux. Continue to monitor that your brand messages are showing up accurately and at scale, while ensuring that your messaging strategy and prioritized sources remain relevant to humans and AI platforms alike.

Top Cited Domains in ChatGPT

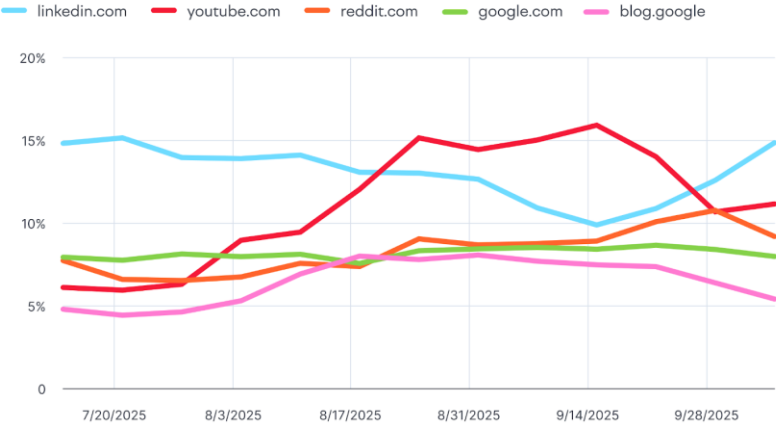


Based on a Semrush study of 230K prompts conducted in October 2025

semrush.com



Top Cited Domains in AI Mode

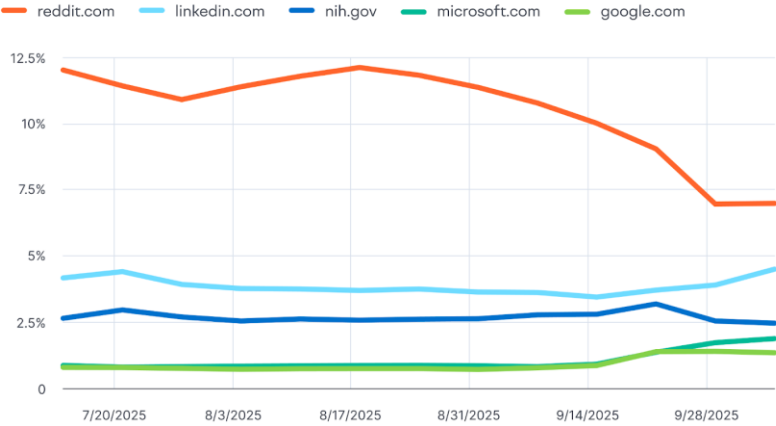


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semrush.com



Top Cited Domains in Perplexity



Based on a Semrush study of 230K prompts conducted in October 2025

semrush.com



Legal & business relationships steer platform direction

Track platform–publisher deals and disputes so your source strategy isn’t built on a relationship that just ended.

Updated Aug 2026

✓

 Formal deal / license

⚖️

 Active lawsuit

🕒

 Settled / licensed after dispute

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AI Platform ↓ / Publisher →	News, Text & Forum Publishers							Images		Creators & Rights Orgs				
	Reddit	Axel Springer	Financial Times	News Corp / Dow Jones	Associated Press	Reuters	NY Times	Condé Nast / Hearst	Shutterstock	Getty Images	Book authors	Visual artists	Music pubs / labels	Hollywood studios
OpenAI Text · Image · Search	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		⚖️	✓	✓		⚖️		⚖️	
Google / Gemini Text · Image · Search	✓		✓		✓				✓					
Microsoft Copilot (uses OpenAI)		✓	✓			✓	⚖️	✓			⚖️			
Meta Text · Image (Llama)				✓		✓			✓		⚖️			
Anthropic Text (Claude)	⚖️										🕒		⚖️	
Amazon Alexa answers							✓	✓	✓					
Perplexity Answer engine	⚖️			⚖️										
Apple Apple Intelligence									✓					
Stability AI Stable Diffusion										⚖️		⚖️		
Midjourney Image · Video												⚖️		⚖️
Runway Image · Video												⚖️		
Suno Music generation													⚖️	

Sources: public company announcements and court filings · as of Aug 2026.

The exercise ensures AI Discoverability adds value without adding a line item

The benefits are the result of treating AI Discoverability as a Key Opinion Leader you need to influence rather than a channel you need to manage.

- 1 The value is already banked**
Because the work was dual-use, the payoff elevates your core marketing practice (accurate PDPs, a consistent entity, keystone content) whether or not AI answers win the category.
- 2 You can defend it on evidence**
Established KPIs make progress measurable without overstating the impact on the business.
- 3 You built a capability, not just a campaign**
Making AI Discoverability a strategic exercise rather than a tactic allows a team to adjust as the underlying landscape continues to shift.